



Kate's **HOMECOMING**

KIRSTEN MCCURRAN

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APHRODITE OMNIMEDIA

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ONE

KATE PLASTERED ON A SMILE WHEN HER DAUGHTER, AVERY, GREETED her outside the dorm building. She was still fuming inside. The entire three-hour drive to Lockley University was spent running down Kate's list of grievances against her husband while trying to drown out her thoughts with the Alt-90s channel on satellite radio but hearing Rage Against the Machine only fed her anger instead of extinguishing it. Daniel should have been in the car with her, doing the driving, but after his latest outrage she told him to stay home.

Tallying reasons to be pissed at Daniel was easy. Like many long-term marriages, theirs had waxed and waned multiple times over their twenty-three years together. They were currently waning big time. Daniel wasn't exactly emotionally available at the best of times, but over the last couple years—since Avery went off to Lockley—he'd been mostly checked out. Kate wondered if he was running out the clock until their son, who was now a high school senior, was out of the house too, but Daniel denied it when she asked. He always had the same excuses. His practice was busy and the pressures of maintaining it were a strain, he loved Kate, but it was natural to lose some of the fire over the years. She understood that, but she wanted the fire back. Little hints here and there didn't work with him, so she moved onto date nights and skimpy lingerie—even sending Daniel sexy selfies, which frankly made Kate feel ridiculous and desperate. Eventually, she tried to convince herself that she didn't care and tried to fill her time with hobbies and gym classes and nights out with the girls. But Kate cared. She cared too much, which was why she was devastated to learn Daniel was having an affair.

Her first reaction upon learning about it was to laugh. Daniel was such a cliché, a dentist fucking one of his hygienists. Kate had never cared for how close he seemed to be with the women—almost all women—who worked in his office, but she always rationalized that Daniel wasn't the type to have an affair. When things were good between them, it was an absurd proposition. Her friends warned her—not always jokingly—that Daniel was going to screw one of those pretty young women in his office, but Kate thought they were crazy. Apparently, not so much.

Kate learned of the affair one night when she pulled into the garage and Daniel's phone suddenly synced to the Bluetooth in her Highlander. Daniel had taken the Highlander to pick up garden supplies the weekend before and must have paired his phone with it. Kate's music cut out, replaced by a giggly, breathy young—god, she sounded so young—woman's voice.

"Baby, are you there? What happened? You didn't come already, did you? I'm not there yet. Don't you dare finish without me."

Kate was too shocked to reply. She'd been listening to Pearl Jam moments before. A glance at the screen on the dash told her she was synced to *Galaxy Note 10* and Nya was on the phone. Nya was an uncommon enough name that it jumped right out at her. Daniel had hired a Nya right out of hygienist school about nine months earlier. She'd interned at his practice before that. Nya was a pretty Filipina girl, petite, with long, silky black hair and beautiful almond eyes. If Kate was his type, she couldn't see how Nya could also be, but then a pretty girl in her twenties was every middle-aged guy's type. It disgusted Kate and not just because Daniel was cheating. Nya was just a few years older than their Avery.

"Are you there?" Nya repeated. "Shit, did the call drop? Baby?"

It was so hard to resist calling the girl a whore, but Kate wanted to hear what else Nya had to say. Nya broke the connection. Moments later, the phone rang through the car and Kate picked up the call without speaking.

"Mmm, are you still hard, baby?" Nya cooed. Kate suppressed a laugh. Daniel had been having some trouble with that in recent years. She blamed herself, but now hoped he didn't stay stiff for Nya either.

Kate had heard enough. She spat, "Does he have that problem with you, too? I've been telling Dan to get Viagra for years, but he's too proud. Maybe he did it for you?"

"Shit," Nya whispered, cutting the call.

Kate sat in the car fuming, steeling for the confrontation awaiting inside the house. She bit back bile and just managed to avoid throwing up. She could handle confrontations but didn't love them. Daniel was probably sitting in there, crafting excuses. He'd somehow try to make this her fault, or at least *their* fault, rather than just being about his own weakness. A thought bubbled up: *your marriage is over*, but Kate pushed that down. She wasn't ready to deal with that.

Daniel was in the great room at the back of their house. Kate was excited about the entertaining possibilities of that room when they bought the house—it had great flow into the open plan kitchen—but now she hated it. The room was always cold in the winter, and it was impossible to reach the cobwebs in the vaulted ceiling without a ladder. The door from the garage led into the kitchen and Kate saw Daniel sitting on their giant sectional as soon as she walked in the house. He stared down at his phone, like he didn't notice she was home.

"Hello," Kate called, waving her hand.

"Oh, hey. I thought you were going to be later."

"Obviously."

"Did you expect me to make dinner? Danny's out. I figured you'd have gotten something before you came home."

Kate dropped her purse on the counter and her gym bag on the floor. She stalked around the counter to stand in front of him, fists on her hips. Daniel looked up, nonplussed, and Kate wished she were more intimidating. She was only five-three, and he was almost a foot taller than her. Even sitting, he didn't have to look up much. When he did, it felt like he looked right through her. It had felt that way for a long time. Kate realized she wasn't exactly a vision with her honey-blonde hair—still damp with sweat—pulled up into a twist with a scrunchie and her baggy tank top-over-sports bra-and-leggings ensemble, but still, it would have been nice to see *some* spark in his eyes. Kate knew he was horny. He'd just been jerking off to phone sex with his girlfriend. Daniel just wasn't horny for *her*. That truth infuriated her even more.

"Really, Daniel?"

"Really what? What did I forget now, Kate?"

"You forgot you're supposed to keep your dick in your pants when you're married, asshole!"

That got his attention. Daniel's eyes went wide, and she saw him putting the pieces together. He didn't realize what had happened when his phone sex session with Nya was interrupted. Daniel must have thought the call just dropped. He held up his hand defensively. It was the hand with his phone. Kate snatched it away.

"I don't know what you think, Kate..."

"I think you're fucking a girl young enough to be your daughter. You creepy asshole!"

"Kate, wait. What did you hear?"

"I heard Nya the Hygienist asking if you came yet. Are you quick on the trigger with her? I guess I could understand..."

"Kate, listen..."

"Please don't tell me you haven't fucked her, or that if you did it doesn't mean anything. Have enough respect for me to save me the bullshit, Daniel."

Daniel sighed, resigned to his fate. Kate was disappointed in a way. She expected more fight out of him. "Okay, yes, I'm sleeping with Nya. I don't know how it happened, but it just happened. She was flirty and we hit it off so well and, I don't know, things here haven't been great, Kate."

"Don't try to put this on me," she protested, thrusting an accusing finger at her husband. "I've tried. I've tried and tried to make things better. You haven't been interested."

"Should either of us have to work so hard? Sometimes it feels like there's this barrier between us, and I don't know how to get through it. Honestly, sometimes I don't know if I want to."

"So your solution was to fuck your twenty-year-old employee?"

"She's twenty-four," he weakly replied.

Kate glared and Daniel shut up. She was bursting with so many conflicting emotions she didn't know where to go with them. Anger, disgust, hurt, maybe even a bit of relief. Kate didn't want a divorce—not before this—but they'd been stuck for so long that maybe something needed to happen to rip the band aid off. She turned away from him and paced. The giant great room was good for that, at least. Kate held a hand to her forehead and tried to coalesce her thoughts.

"I'm sorry, Kate. I don't know what else to say," Daniel said. "Is it over?"

“Are you asking because you want to stay married or because you don’t want to lose half your practice? I don’t know how to answer that, Daniel. I don’t know how to make this right. How do I balance the scales? Should I go out and fuck someone too?”

Tentatively, Daniel answered, “If you feel you need to...”

“You don’t seriously think I could just go out and screw someone for payback and everything would be fixed, do you? Maybe I could pick up one of those hot young trainers at the gym.”

“Do you want that?”

“What are you saying, Daniel?” She stopped pacing and stared at him.

“I don’t know what I’m saying, Kate. But I do know that neither of us has been happy for a while, and it’s not all my fault. You’re an incredible mother, and you’ve been a good wife. You keep our lives on track.”

“Like a secretary?”

“That’s not what I’m saying. I’m just trying to say that most of our life works, but the passion’s been gone for a while now. I don’t know how to get it back. I don’t know how we see each other the way we used to, and that’s not all on me either, Kate. You don’t look at me the way you used to. Maybe if we had some kind of arrangement, we could make it work.”

“Let me get this straight. Your solution to you cheating on me is that we should have an open marriage? We just go out and fuck whoever we want but come home and act like a happy family. You think that would work?”

“I don’t know, Kate. But I do know this isn’t working, but I love our family and I love our life, and I don’t want you out of it. I think an open marriage could be the solution.”

Kate looked around for something to throw at him. A decorative vase sat on the mantle, but she knew she’d have to clean up that mess too. Instead, she said, “I need to be away from you right now.”

“But this weekend...”

“Will be the perfect opportunity to get some space from you. I need to think, Daniel. Don’t push me right now.”

“What will we tell Avery?”

“You can make up some excuse.”

“You’re just going to go on your own?”

“You should be thrilled. You can spend the weekend screwing Nya.”

“Kate, come on....”

“And maybe I’ll meet some handsome college professor. Your dream of an open marriage might come true.”

TWO

"I AM SO HAPPY TO SEE YOU, KID," KATE SAID, HAULING HER daughter into a crushing embrace.

"Okay, Mom. Geez, I need to breathe, y'know," Avery replied, hugging her mother back much less intensely.

"Sorry, I just miss you. You're so far away."

"It's only been a couple months since I was home. Are you alright?"

Kate pulled back and looked up at her daughter. It was still strange to look up at her own kid, even though Avery had been taller than her mother since the age of fourteen. Avery had gotten the height genes from her dad. Both the kids had. Danny was just as tall as his father. Sometimes it felt like poor petite Kate was living in the land of giants.

"Everything's fine. I'm allowed to miss you."

"Yeah, Mom. Okay. Just you're acting weird, and Dad's not here. It's sus."

"Didn't he call you?"

"He texted. I didn't know dentists have emergencies on weekends. I don't remember that being a thing before."

"It doesn't happen a lot, but it's happened, sweetie. Your dad has to do things like emergency root canals for good patients."

"I guess. I just know the way you guys treat this weekend. It's like your Christmas," Avery said, laughing.

"You'll get it when you're our age. I hope you look back on your college days with as much fondness as we do."

"Are you still going to subject me to the tour of all your old hot spots?"

“We can skip that this time,” Kate quickly replied. She didn’t need a tour of how she and Daniel fell in love.

“Are you sure you’re okay, Mom?”

“Yeah, definitely Ave. We’d better get moving if we want to make kick off. Traffic was much worse than I expected.”

They stopped in Avery’s dorm before heading over to the stadium so Kate could freshen up after her long drive. They painted Lockley University’s interlocking “LU” symbol on each other’s cheeks in the school’s blue and white colors and donned their school gear. It was a warm fall day, but Kate still wore a long-sleeved Lockley t-shirt with jeans and a Lockley ball cap. Avery opted for a tank top and shorts, only taking along a sweatshirt—in case she got chilly—at her mother’s insistence. Properly geared up, they joined the crowd waiting for a shuttlebus to the field.

Mother and daughter had to clasp hands to keep track of each other once they joined the throngs of fans flowing into the athletics complex. Lockley was a small state school that played Division II football and the football field was the centerpiece of the athletics complex. The stands could accommodate over three thousand fans, but the entire area was packed with students, alumni, and parents for the homecoming game. The day was filled with activities, most of which Kate missed because of the horrific traffic coming into town. She’d planned to come up the night before but got stuck at work. Baseball and field hockey games occurred earlier in the day, but the centerpiece of the day was the football game versus Lockley’s rival Richmond University. A concert was scheduled immediately after the game, and there would be parties all across the campus and throughout the little college town all night.

Being in the crowd of fans at her old stomping grounds brought back a flood of memories for Kate. She had the best time in college. She’d been serious about her studies, but still knew how to party, especially during football season. Kate was no stranger to the parties thrown at the frats after games and did a lot of things that would probably stun her daughter—if they ever came out. She avoided thinking of Avery doing some of the same things she did back in the day. The world just felt more dangerous now, even though that was just perception, Kate realized. There was nothing innocent about frat boys trying to get her drunk enough to go up to their rooms, but it didn’t feel sinister back then. It was just part of campus life. Consent wasn’t even a discussion in her college days. Girlfriends knew to

watch each other's backs to keep each other out of trouble. Kate and her friends were always good about that, even though there were a couple times when she was with a cute guy and had to reassure her friends she didn't need rescuing.

It was at one of those crazy parties that Kate met Daniel. He was a senior when she was a sophomore. Kate was cornered by a frat brother who didn't want to take no for an answer. She held her own, but he was getting increasingly handsy and she was looking for a way past him. Kate might have slugged him if Daniel didn't come to her rescue. Daniel pushed past the guy and insisted Kate was there to meet him. He slipped an arm around her and even kissed Kate when the guy protested. She always thought it was funny that their first kiss was as strangers. But Daniel was cute and a good kisser, so she didn't mind. Kate pulled him down to her, making for a very convincing smooch. They spent the rest of that night together, although she didn't sleep with him. Daniel had to wait a couple weeks for that. Kate was seeing someone else and had to extricate herself from that situation. It felt slutty to be sleeping with two men at once. Daniel didn't seem to care about the other guy, which she always found odd. He was just too sweet to be a manslut just interested in sex.

They kept dating long distance when he graduated and started dental school. When Kate graduated with her business degree two years later, they moved in together. They were supposed to be exclusive during the time they were six hours apart, but Kate had her doubts about Daniel. She had no proof, just a feeling. It could have been spurred by guilt as she wasn't exactly innocent. Kate hooked up two or three times in that period. She didn't have sex with anyone else, but there were a few nights where she had too much to drink, met a cute guy, and let things get out of hand. Kate never confessed, knowing it would just be to assuage her own guilt, and only hurt Daniel. She didn't think it made a difference as she was fully faithful once they were back in the same city together. The past was the past. Now she almost wished she'd gone further and fucked those college guys. She could throw it in Daniel's face and tell him she cheated first. Although, given his open marriage comments, and his attitude about the other guy when they first met, he might not care.

Avery found her friends in the stands, and they joined them. Kate thought her daughter's friends were good girls and she liked them all. She did feel like something of a fifth wheel, hanging out with a bunch of college

girls, but they did their best to include her in the group. It was impressive that they didn't get uptight being around a parent. Kate wouldn't have been so easygoing about a parent hanging around back in her college days, but today's kids were much more relaxed. They didn't even hesitate to pass Kate a beer when they popped open their cooler.

Technically, alcohol was not allowed at Lockley games, but it was loosely enforced on normal Saturdays, and not at all during Homecoming. Kate remembered getting blasted during her homecoming games as a student and staggering around the campus, giggling with her friends, afterwards. Those were fond memories and Kate had to suppress her parental instinct to make her daughter follow the rules. She didn't want to deny Avery those memories or be seen as a killjoy by her daughter's friends. Kate wanted to be the cool mom and that was why she took the beer when it was passed to her. And the next one and the one after that.

The football game was such a blowout in favor of the home team that by halftime the action on the field didn't matter. They still cheered the home team touchdowns, but the excitement ramped up high when the all-decade team was introduced during a halftime ceremony. Kate noted that even all of those all-decade players were younger than her but chose to focus on her beer rather than dwell on it. After a while, she really saw herself as just one of the girls and she felt like a coed again. The trouble with Daniel and his whore was forgotten and Kate let it go and enjoyed herself.

A concert was planned in the adjoining field after the 56-10 Lockley victory, but Avery and her friends weren't interested, so their group moved through the milling crowd back toward the shuttle bus stop. The crowd gathering there was insane, so the girls decided to hoof it back rather than wait. Kate was happy for the walk to clear her head of the buzz from too many beers. The walk turned warm, and Kate ended up shedding the long-sleeved Lockley t-shirt, tying it around her waist. She was comfortable in the white tank she wore underneath.

Back at the dorms, the girls went their separate ways. Kate offered to take them all to an early dinner, but Avery's friends had plans and wanted to get ready. They asked if Avery would be coming to whatever big party they were excited about, and she told them she'd have to see.

Kate felt a pang of guilt, knowing she was holding her daughter back from the party. Avery spent virtually the whole weekend with her parents the year before, attending the university's evening events, which closed

with a small fireworks display back at the athletic complex. But Avery had been a shy freshman then and hadn't made many friends yet. Everything had changed in a year. Kate was proud to see her daughter blossom. She truly wanted Avery to have the best college experience, just like she'd had. If Kate had been there with Daniel, there would have been more pressure for Avery to spend the evening with her parents, but with it being just Kate the calculus was different. Daniel wouldn't have been shy about razzing Avery for abandoning them. Kate wasn't that selfish.

They arrived in Avery's dorm room, and she dropped onto her bed. Kate found it amusing that her daughter was more worn out by the two-mile walk than she was. Kate was just getting warmed up and pleased at the chance to get her steps in. Avery's roommate was out, and Kate sat on her bed and took off her Lockley baseball cap. She ran her fingers through her honey blonde hair, fluffing it out past her shoulders.

"You know, you can go to that party if you want, Ave," she said. Kate took off her sunglasses and exchanged them for her regular glasses from her purse.

"It's no big deal, Mom. I'm hanging out with you this weekend. I miss you and dad."

"Sorry again he couldn't be here. I know he really wanted to see you."

"I know. It's okay. You're here."

"So, if you want to go out with your friends..."

"Mom, I'm not abandoning you after you drove so long to get up here. I'm not that girl."

"I know, Avery. And I love how thoughtful you are. I couldn't be prouder. You don't have to prove anything to me. I want you to go out and have fun."

"I have fun with you, Mom."

"You should be out having fun with your friends, not your mother. It's different."

Kate saw her daughter was torn. She desperately wanted to go to the party with her friends, but she didn't want to run out on her mother. Avery really was a sweet girl. Kate was a good kid at that age too, but she knew she would have taken off running if offered the same choice. But then, Kate's mom wasn't nearly as much fun as she was. Kate loved her mother dearly, but she was not someone she would have wanted to spend Homecoming weekend with at twenty. Kate decided to give Avery a nudge.

“I could always come to the party with you guys. We all had fun at the game this afternoon, right?” Kate offered.

Avery tried to hide it, but her horror at Kate’s suggestion was plain. “Mom, I don’t think you’d have any fun. It’s not like the football game, it’s like...”

Watching her daughter stammer made Kate smile. She said, “I know what homecoming weekend parties are like, Ave. I didn’t go to college in the stone age. It’s okay. You’re right, I wouldn’t fit in there. I would feel silly trying. But I want you to go. Seriously, Avery. No more arguments. You go and have fun tonight and we’ll meet up for breakfast in the morning.”

“Are you sure, Mom?”

“I’m sure, and if you ask me again, I’m going to borrow an outfit from you, and I *am* going to go to that party and flirt with all the college boys.”

Avery looked horrified, but she knew her mother wasn’t serious. “You wouldn’t dare, Mom. And *gross*.” She laughed.

“Come here,” Kate said, pulling her daughter into a fierce hug. “I love you kid.”

“Breakfast won’t be too early, right?” Avery asked.

They both laughed.

THREE

KATE CHECKED INTO HER HOTEL, FULLY INTENDING TO ORDER IN FOOD and chill out for the night. She scrubbed the spirit paint off her cheek and laid down on the bed with the TV on a news channel. Now that she'd taken a moment to slow down, the long day was hitting her, and she was worn out. It had been a rough few days. But she was restless. Kate had too much time on her hands and couldn't help thinking about the state of her marriage, and what Daniel might be doing while she was gone for the weekend. She'd like to think he'd called things off with Nya when he was caught, Kate wasn't that naïve. It turned her stomach, but Kate imagined Daniel with Nya, in their bed, that very moment, the lithe young hygienist bouncing on top of her husband, wishing the middle-aged man stayed hard longer. Unless Nya had a thing for older, daddy types, Kate figured she must be used to young guys who stayed hard all night.

It had been so long since Kate had that—decades—she barely remembered what it was like. Kate knew there was a campus full of hard young dicks out there that could take care of her tonight and the thought of going out there and seducing a college boy—Mrs. Robinson-style—made her laugh out loud in the hotel room. Kate thought of the MILF fetish she'd first learned about in the movie *American Pie*, long before she was a mother herself, but couldn't imagine any of the boys at Lockley were looking for a late-forties mom who wanted to get back at her husband.

Still, Kate couldn't just kick back in her hotel room. She had to get out. She ran a brush through her hair, touched up her make-up, tossed her Lockley baseball cap back on, and headed back out onto the campus.

The pull of nostalgia was strong, and Kate couldn't resist visiting all the old haunts. They predictably stirred memories of fun times with Daniel. She walked through the quad, where they were supposed to be out on the lawn studying together but ended up making out on the blanket as often as not. She walked past the old brownstone where Daniel had a walk-up apartment on the third floor. Kate was still in the dorms then, but most nights were spent in Daniel's apartment—and bed. The parties in that apartment were out on control and Kate smiled thinking about just how many people they managed to cram into such a tiny space. Somehow there was still always enough space at the kitchen table to play quarters. Some of those late games got quite risqué when it was down to just the core group of friends.

It would never fly today, but many of the rules made during quarters involved the girls present having to take something off or do something sexually daring. Guys often had to strip too, but no one really seemed to care about that. One night Daniel's roommate Tommy made a rule that Kate had to kiss every guy who got the coin in the shot glass. Those kisses started out as pecks, but when Daniel sunk three quarters in a row and had the chance to rescind the rule—and didn't—Kate ramped up the kissing to spite him. Kate made out with three of Daniel's friends right in front of him that night, and he didn't bat an eye. She had to make out with the other girls present more than once, but she didn't care about that. The girls were soft kissers, and it didn't mean anything. Kissing other girls was pleasant, but Kate didn't generally lean that way. Having to strip down to her panties was the hardest thing Kate ever had to do, and she probably wouldn't have if she weren't so drunk. She wasn't the flashing type. She'd turned her back to the room when she'd stripped her top and bra off, and held her hands over her breasts when she turned back to face the group. Her turn to shoot came back around and Kate tried to cover her breasts with one arm and failed spectacularly. Her breasts weren't huge, but they spilled out when she moved. After that, Kate gave up and let the guys in the room stare as much as they wanted. It had been strangely empowering, and more arousing than she ever wanted to admit. She was all over Daniel that night when they were finally alone. Thinking back, Kate realized that he didn't care that all his friends were staring at her tits at that party. Daniel even encouraged them to look.

Getting girls drunk and making rules for them to strip and be touched was appropriately a relic of the past and she was glad Avery didn't have to

deal with such things, although she couldn't picture her strong-willed daughter going along with such hijinks. Kate, however, didn't feel scarred by such memories. Those were just things that happened, and she didn't feel any of the boys around her were truly malicious. No one knew any better. And sometimes, Kate wondered where that daring, wild girl she'd been had gone.

Kate passed the library and recalled how many surreptitious blowjobs she gave in the stacks—and not just to Daniel. She only stopped when she was on the verge of getting a reputation for moving too fast with boys she just met. Kate loved the opportunity to explore her sexuality for the first time—freed from the yoke of her parents—but keeping her good girl reputation intact still mattered to her. She laughed, thinking about how many of her most vivid college memories revolved around sex somehow. It was incredible how she and Daniel edited all of that out when they gave Avery the tour of their history. Kate was sad to see that the old greasy spoon diner they always stumbled to late at night had been converted to an upscale eatery. She craved a cup of midnight black coffee and an order of greasy French fries with brown gravy—an indulgence she rarely allowed herself these days. Keeping fit at forty-eight wasn't as easy as it had been at twenty. Kate finally came to the bar that was their frequent haunt way back when, and decided to stop in and have a beer.

Carey's Taphouse—it was just Carey's in her day—was a cavernous bar with three levels. It occupied an old nineteenth century hotel that had been a way station when Millville was a sleepy little town in coal country, long before there was a Lockley University. The main floor was mostly open space with booths along the walls and an ancient bar that looked to date back to the building's hotel days. Little had changed there since her college days. The tatty faux-leather booth upholstery hadn't even been updated, just duct taped where it had been picked at by drunken college kids. The floor was scuffed and filthy. The bar itself had no stools, which were too convenient a weapon when one of the semi-frequent fights broke out. Lockley tried to have the bar shut down as a nuisance more than once, but the owners always dodged the court action with promises to clean up their act. The downstairs was a tight space where bands played to students packed so tightly, they barely had room to jump up and down to the beat. Loud music floated up from the basement when Kate walked in, and she was tempted to go down and see if it was like the old days. Upstairs at

Carey's was set up like a laidback lounge, with couches and tables seemingly randomly tossed about, and a couple dartboards on the walls. Those couches would glow like a purple sun if examined under a blacklight. They were where tipsy students went with the boys or girls they picked up when they couldn't wait to get home. No one paid much attention to what went on in the shadows unless they liked to watch. You didn't hook up there if you were concerned with being watched.

The crowd was lighter than it would be on a typical Saturday night, but Carey's was far from empty. A lot of people were at off-campus homecoming parties or one of Lockley's official events. Kate still had to mutter several *excuse mes* as she navigated the crowd of students to reach the bar. She drew attention. She was probably one of the few parents who had ever stepped foot in Carey's. It wasn't on the usual tour when students showed their parents around campus. Some of the guys in the crowd gave Kate a second glance and she couldn't help feeling they were checking her out. That was silly, she knew. College boys weren't looking for her. Kate was convinced the MILF thing didn't really exist outside of *American Pie* and porn.

A broad-chested, muscular young man was tending bar and at first, he didn't notice Kate crammed in between other patrons. He looked like he was barely older than the college students he was serving. Kate raised a hand and waved, and he took notice. The bartender did a double take when he realized she wasn't just another college student. He used a damp rag to wipe down the bar in front of her before asking what she wanted.

"I'll take a Yuengling bottle," she said, raising her voice to be heard over the crowd.

"Sorry, only tap on weekend nights. The bottles can be trouble."

"Makes sense. Tap is fine."

"Okay," he replied.

The row of taps was directly to her left: Coors Light, Budweiser, Bud Light, Yuengling and Rolling Rock. Kate couldn't remember the last time she saw that kind of line up in a bar. She usually went to a local brew pub with their friends, or at least an upscale bar with a wide selection of microbrews and premium beers. There probably wasn't much call for an expensive pint of Guinness at Carey's. Back in her day, Killian's Irish Red was the big deal beer they sold at Carey's, and a lot of her friends drank MGD. Kate didn't know if Killian's was even still a thing. The bartender

took a plastic cup from a sleeve behind the bar and expertly filled it with little head. She was impressed. The beers from the tap were mostly head when she was a student. He placed it down in front of her and asked for three-fifty.

“You’re not going to card me? I’m a bit concerned by your lax procedures,” she said, with a smile.

He returned her smile and leaned in, so he didn’t have to shout. “I bet you have an excellent fake ID.” He leaned in and added, “Besides, I let all the sexy girls drink. You must be used to that.”

Kate’s smile widened. “Some things never change. I never needed a fake ID here if I wore a top that was low cut enough, or a short enough skirt.”

“Past tense? Let me guess, you’re a grad student. Don’t come in much anymore?”

“You’re cute and charming. I hope my daughter stays away from you. She’d be in trouble.”

“I promise, I’m a gentleman. And I think her mother’s pretty hot, so you have nothing to worry about.”

“So glad you didn’t make a joke about getting both of us in bed.”

“That would be a little weird. You’re more than enough woman for me anyway.”

“Smooth. Do you hit on all the moms?”

He laughed. He had a great smile, which only made Kate smile more. “They never come in here. You being here at my bar officially makes you the coolest mom on this campus. I think if any other kids dragged their parents here, they’d turn up their nose and walk away.”

“My daughter didn’t drag me here. She’s off at some party having fun. I didn’t feel like spending the night alone in my hotel room.”

“Good for you. That makes you even cooler. How did you end up here of all places?”

“This was my regular haunt, back...” Kate was going to say *back when I went to school here*, but didn’t want to sound like a middle-aged soccer mom trying to relive her old glories. She didn’t want to be that cliché.

“Back last week?” he asked.

“Sweet, but you don’t have to keep buttering me up.”

“That depends. Is it working?”

Kate couldn't stop smiling at the younger man. Her mind began going dirty places it shouldn't. "You're doing pretty well. If I was available, you'd definitely be in the running." She held up her hand, waving her wedding band in his face.

"Where is the good husband?"

"Oh, he's back at home. Don't worry about him. I'm sure he's not lonely."

"It's like that, is it? Sounds like you need something stronger."

"That's really not necessary."

"I insist."

The bartender slapped an empty plastic shot glass on the bar and tipped a bottle of cheap whiskey over it. Kate stared at it warily.

"I don't know. Maybe if you do it with me?"

"I'm not supposed to drink on duty," he replied, pausing to pretend-consider it. "I guess I can make an exception—if you tell me your name."

"I'm Kate."

"Awesome to meet you, Kate. I'm Alexi."

Alexi the bartender offered his hand and then poured himself a shot alongside Kate's. He lifted his shot and said, "To the funnest mom!"

"Is that a word?" she asked, laughing.

"Does it matter? It's Saturday night and we're drinking."

"Good point."

They knocked back their shots and Kate gave a little shiver as the amber liquid burned her throat on the way down. She rarely drank whiskey to begin with, and if she did, it was the good stuff Daniel preferred, not the cheap, off-brand stuff poured in a college bar. And she certainly didn't do shots anymore. But once the burning passed, a pleasing warmth spread through her chest. Kate's shot days were behind her, but she'd always enjoyed doing shots back in the day. The heat reached her cheeks, giving them a rosy glow.

"Another?" Alexi asked.

"I thought you were a nice guy, but now you're trying to get me drunk."

"I don't want you doing anything you don't want to, Kate."

"I never said I didn't want to get drunk," she replied, eyes sparkling behind her glasses. She tapped the bar beside her empty glass. It was crazy, but Kate had a sudden urge to get a little crazy.

Alexi smiled. "That's what I'm talking about."

He poured her a second shot and Kate knocked it back without hesitation. It still burned, but the second shot went down easier. Her cheeks turned a brighter pink and the warmth in her chest spread.

“I’ve got to go do my job, Kate, but I’ll be off in a few hours. If you’re still around, we can hang out.”

“Hang out?” she asked, amused. Being hit on by a bartender in his twenties was just what she needed to lift her spirits. Who knew?

“Like I said, whatever you want, Kate.”

“I plan to hang out for a while. We’ll see if I’m still here when you get off,” she teased.

Alexi went off to serve the people impatiently waiting for him, and Kate wandered off to see what else was going on in the bar. She would be in the bar for a while, but she had no intention of being there late enough to meet Alexi after his shift. That would only lead to trouble, and Kate wasn’t looking to get *that* crazy. Besides, that would be way past her bedtime.

The stairs leading down to the live performance space in the basement were narrow and Kate had to maneuver past students to get down there. The girls she passed gave her a wide berth, but the couple of guys she encountered on the stairs barely left room for Kate to squeeze past them. They didn’t give her the deference she expected they would to a parent, and she wondered if they realized she was one. The stairs were dimly lit, and Kate liked to think that in her Lockley hat and t-shirt she could pass as a coed in the poor light. She rubbed bodies with the first guy she encountered and was then caught between two of them for a moment.

A hand slid over her ass and stayed there. Kate chose to be flattered, rather than offended. She couldn’t recall the last time a random guy tried to grope her ass. Totally inappropriate, of course, but it was nice to be noticed. Those two whiskey shots helped with her state of mind. Being inappropriate was newly appealing. Kate allowed the hand to linger and then pressed past the second boy, who had the temerity to slip a hand around her waist and hold her a moment, mashing her breasts into his chest. Kate smiled wickedly—the kid couldn’t see it—and wiggled against him before pushing past, saying, “Excuse me.”

“Uh, sorry, lost my balance,” the boy muttered.

Kate emerged at the bottom of the stairs into a dark, deep, wide, low-ceilinged room, about three-quarters full of bopping students. It was just like how she remembered it, except that back in her college days the kids

would have been packed in body-to-body, sweating, and writhing against each other to grunge rock. The band on the low stage at the back of the room that night played anthemic pop-rock, akin to Imagine Dragons. Kate liked that band—as modern music went—but didn't know their music well enough to know if the song was a cover of that band or an original. It didn't much matter. It was good to be in a fun, energetic crowd.

The rhythm possessed her, and Kate moved her body with the music as she advanced into the room, holding her beer high to keep from spilling it. She twisted and turned as she danced, moving forward into the crowd. The disadvantage of being so short was that her view was always blocked by a crowd. Kate carved out a space in the middle of the crowd where she could intermittently see the band playing in the front of the room, fitting in with the bodies moving around her just like she was one of the students.

A few of the young people around her gave Kate second glances and noted she was the one thing not like the others. No one bothered her, leaving Kate alone to enjoy the music and her beer. The music blasting from the band's amplifiers was deafening and Kate's body vibrated with the baseline. She hadn't experienced anything like it in ages. She and Daniel still went to concerts, but they were mostly nostalgia acts playing big arenas. Kate loved to get up and dance, but it was at her seat, and she could sit when she wanted a break. Carey's basement was an altogether different experience. When Kate tried to stop moving, the crowd surrounding her kept Kate's body in motion. The air in the basement was oppressively humid and the heat of the bodies around her had Kate feeling dizzy. In her head, she blamed the shots she did back at the bar. Kate wasn't ready to admit she was too old to hang. The reason didn't matter. After a handful of songs, she needed a break and pushed back through the crowd to find the stairs.

Kate finished her beer and stopped at the main bar for a fresh one. She had a moment of vanity over Alexi seeing her flushed and sweaty from the basement but shrugged it off. The handsome bartender was just working her for a good tip. She was probably the only person in the bar likely to give him one. And Kate would. His flirting made her feel good, so he earned it.

Alexi came right over this time and Kate asked for a beer and a water. He gave her a *tsk tsk* at the water. "You're not slowing down already are you, Kate?"

"Not at all, but it's smart to stay hydrated. With age comes wisdom."

“Good point. If you want to get some fresh air, I was about to take a break. You wanna...”

Kate knew she shouldn't be going anywhere with the hot bartender, but the beer and shots were already working on her and she agreed. Alexi told the other bartender he was taking his break and motioned for Kate to follow him when he went to the end of the bar to duck through the opening. She was led down a long, dark hallway she didn't remember, toward a back room. Kate didn't recall ever hooking up with a bartender at Carey's and would have had no reason to go to the backroom.

Alexi took her hand and pulled her to the left, leading Kate through a side door that opened onto a narrow, poorly-lit alleyway. It smelled of damp garbage, but it was still great to suck the cold air into her lungs. The cold instantly chilled the sweat under her shirt, giving her goosebumps and a shiver. The bartender shook out a cigarette and offered Kate one, but she declined. That was a bad habit she'd never indulged.

“Are you up here for homecoming?” Alexi asked, exhaling a huge cloud of smoke.

“Yep. It's sort of a tradition. My husband and I both went here, and now our daughter is a student.” Kate sipped her beer.

“That's cool. They have a lot going on this weekend. Tons of parents and alumni visiting. None of them make their way to Carey's, though. Like I said, it makes you the coolest parent on campus this weekend.”

“I have a lot of great memories in this place. I guess I wanted to see if it lived up to the memories. Have to say, not much has changed. In the bar, that is. I've changed a lot.”

Alexi smiled and it warmed her against the nighttime chill. “I doubt you've changed all that much. You look great, but if anything, I bet you're even hotter now.”

Kate patted his chest and laughed. “You really don't have to. I don't need the ego boost.”

“I mean it, Kate. You're hot, and you're still the same girl who hung out here. You can't be that different.”

“It feels like a lifetime ago. Most of the time, I can't even remember who that girl was. But it is starting to come back to me being back here.”

“What was so different about that Kate?”

So many things, she thought. That Kate would still be downstairs dancing, for starters. That Kate would be flirting just as hard as Alexi was.

And that Kate wouldn't stop at flirting after a couple beers and a couple shots—not with a boy as gorgeous as Alexi. His blonde hair was raked straight back and fell past his collar. It looked like it hadn't been washed in a few days. College Kate wouldn't have slowed down to notice that. College Kate would be lost in those hazel eyes and that square jaw and would have craved feeling his stubbly cheeks as they kissed. Mom Kate didn't differ on that last point. As she looked up at Alexi, she very much wanted to kiss him and feel that stubble. College Kate would have been shoving her tits at him to encourage him to make his move. Mom Kate stood there, torn between longing and the impulse to flee.

“That Kate would be giggling and flirty and honestly throwing herself at you. This Kate is a married woman who doesn't throw herself at men like that anymore.”

Alexi smiled and it made her heart flutter. How many times had she felt those butterflies in her stomach leaning against a wall outside of Carey's with a handsome boy?

“But does this Kate want to do that?” he asked.

Kate batted her eyes and thrust her chest out at him. “How's that?”

“Sexy, but you don't need it.”

The hunky bartender grabbed Kate and kissed her, taking her breath away. She was just tipsy enough to return the kiss without hesitation and hungrily mashed her lips to his. It had been ages since she'd kissed a boy and tasted cigarettes on his lips. She'd never liked it, but it was a powerful reminder she was not kissing her husband, and it made her heart race. Alexi was the first new man she'd kissed in decades. It was thrilling. Kate wound her fist in his shirt and pulled him to her, pressing her body against his. Alexi had almost half a foot on her and when he grabbed her ass, he almost lifted her off the ground. She wished she had someplace to put her beer so she could get both hands on him. He aggressively kneaded her round ass through her tight jeans. Kate realized she missed being handled like that. She snaked her tongue into his mouth.

Kate dropped her beer, letting the plastic cup splash on the concrete and held onto the back of his neck, as if she was afraid he'd try to slip away. She hungered for him. Alexi turned them and pressed Kate against the rough stone wall. Her baseball cap was pushed back and almost fell to the ground. His hands roamed her body like thieves trying to steal their way beneath her clothing. He groped her breasts through her shirt, but the touch

was frustratingly brief. His fingers probed at her waist, and she wondered if he was trying to find his way into her jeans or her shirt. Kate felt that old buzz that came from hooking up with a boy for the first time. It was like a drug she hadn't realized she'd missed. A surge of pleasure throbbed through her when his hand went north, fingers sliding over the smooth cup of her bra. It was lightly padded, as almost all her bras were these days, but his massaging fingers still swelled her nipple to excitement, and she moaned into their kiss.

The guilt began to creep in. Kate desperately tried to push it away, but it was an insistent thing, moving in like a heavy fog that dampened her excitement. That wasn't quite true. Her entire body ached for Alexi and if she gave him another few minutes to work on her, she'd be ready for him to peel her jeans down and fuck her right there in the alley. But Kate wasn't a twenty-year-old college kid. She was a responsible forty-eight-year-old wife and mother. The wife part shouldn't have mattered, given what Daniel had done, but cheating still felt wrong. Another couple drinks, a few more minutes of wild making out in the alley and Kate could get past that and at least ignore the guilt long enough to get laid. But the mom part mattered, and her daughter was somewhere out there on that campus. Imagine if they were caught out there by the cops or something. Once it was in her head, the fear of getting caught spiked through her. If only Alexi had taken her into the stockroom, he'd have had a chance. But Kate could not let him fuck her in that alley. She could not risk getting caught with her pants literally down in public and Avery finding out.

Kate groaned and pushed Alexi away. She was panting and licked her wet lips. He reached for her again and she had to look away from him to find the courage to stop. "I can't. Not here, not like this," she stammered.

"You sure? You don't seem like you want to stop," he said, moving in again.

"Really, I can't. Sorry."

A new fear stabbed at her. What if Alexi didn't let her go? She didn't know him. They were alone in the alley. Kate realized this was probably his move, pulling some drunk college girl into the alley for a quickie with her skirt pushed up. She knew she wasn't the first female he'd had in that alley, but probably the first *woman*. But then Alexi stepped back, with his hands raised, and Kate decided she may have misjudged him in her panic, which made her desire for him return. It would be exciting to the first *woman*, the

first MILF he'd had in that alley. Kate wanted to be the kind of hot momma who'd fuck the sexy bartender in the alley. But she just wasn't quite there... yet.

"It's cool. I know it's a leap," he said, smiling through his obvious disappointment.

"It's not that I don't want to," she hurriedly added.

"I will be off in a couple hours, if you want..."

"If I'm still around," she replied, impulsively pulling him down into a last kiss before pushing him away. She had never been so conflicted. It was like bees buzzing in her head, confusing her.

Kate followed him back inside and diverted to the ladies' room when he went to the bar. She fixed her disheveled clothes and cleaned her glasses, which were smeared by fooling around. She had to fix her lipstick in the grungy mirror too but was otherwise intact. The smart thing would have been to go right back to the hotel, because if she stayed and was still there when Alexi finished his shift, she would go home with him. Deep down, Kate knew it. And that would be bad. But she needed a moment to reset. Instead of walking out the door, she chose the upstairs lounge area, purposely avoiding looking to the bar and Alexi when she passed them.

The upstairs lounge was even dimmer than Kate remembered it. Except for a couple small spotlights aimed at the dart boards, and another on a shuffleboard table, the lounge was illuminated by low red lights. From what she could make out in the poor lighting, the ratty couches along the walls were the same ones that had been there twenty-five years ago. It put a smile on her face. The one change was a small bar had been installed on the short wall near the top of the stairs. The bar downstairs was the only one in her college days. Kate made a beeline for the bar and ordered both a fresh beer and a bottle of water. She knew it was a bad idea, but she needed a drink. She took off her ballcap and fanned herself with it while she waited for the pretty girl behind the bar to bring her drinks. The water was only lukewarm, but it was just what she needed, and Kate drained it in about a minute.

The lounge was sparsely populated. If she squinted into the darkness, Kate could see young bodies moving on the couch. She decided they were just sitting there chatting, but Kate didn't stare too long, lest she see something she didn't want to. She knew what she'd done on those couches on drunken, horny nights. Kate distracted herself by moving to the unoccupied shuffleboard table.

Kate knew she'd drawn some attention as she set up the shuffleboard table but tried to ignore it. She could only imagine what the students must be thinking. Why was a middle-aged woman alone in a bar like that on a Saturday night? Most of them probably correctly surmised she was a parent there for Homecoming, but surely some of them suspected she was a local cougar on the prowl for a studly college student. Kate still didn't consider herself on the prowl for anything, but she could still taste Alexi's smokey lips on hers and she knew that she remained at the bar because it was in the back of her mind to go home with him when his shift ended. She'd felt his rock-hard bulge pushing into her stomach when they kissed. Kate could have it if she wanted, but that was insane. Maybe she was on the prowl and just couldn't admit it. Rather than deal with all that, she focused on her shuffleboard game.

"Are you up for a match?"

The voice came from beside Kate, and she glanced to her right to find a boy with a goofy, confident grin. He was handsome, in an unassuming way, tall and slender. He wasn't the male specimen that Alexi the bartender was, but he was appealing in his own way. Kate liked the way his dark hair flopped over his forehead, hiding his eyes. She kicked herself for noticing all of that because he really was a boy to her. He couldn't have been more than a couple years older than Avery—probably younger than Alexi if he was a student. He could have been a boy her daughter brought home.

"I don't know. My skills have deteriorated. You'd find me too easy," she answered, matching his smile.

"You look like a pro to me. I've been watching you play."

"Have you? It really is a slow night on campus."

"I don't know. I'm enjoying myself. Can't think of anything else I'd rather be doing."

Kate laughed. "That, I don't believe. With everything going on this weekend, there's nothing you'd rather be doing than hanging out here and watching me play shuffleboard? Come on now."

"What can I say? I appreciate your form... Sorry, I didn't catch your name. I'm Cal."

"That's because I didn't say it. Are you really trying to pick me up, Cal?" She rested one hand on the shuffleboard table and the other on her cocked hip. It was impossible to believe that two twentysomething boys were hitting on her in the space of an hour.

Cal regarded her over his beer as he took a sip. His eyes swept her body but locked in on her baby blue eyes. The kid knew how to make serious eye contact and Kate liked the buzz it gave her. The feelings Alexi stirred in her had died down to a dull roar, but Cal was amping them up again. It was difficult to tell with the low lighting and his hair in the way, but she thought his eyes were hazel.

“Truth? I noticed you downstairs while the band was playing, but then you disappeared. I’m glad I caught up with you up here.”

“Are you stalking me, Cal? Should I be concerned?” Kate was mortified that Cal may have seen her go off with Alexi. If he had, it wasn’t slowing him down.

“Is chatting up a pretty girl in a bar stalking?”

“I’m not exactly a *girl*, Cal.”

“Which is what makes you so interesting. I had to know what you’re doing here.”

Kate laughed again. The kid was charming. She’d give him that. “Like, *what’s a nice girl like you doing in a place like this?*”

Cal clearly didn’t get the reference, and Kate felt old. He replied, “Sure. What is a girl like you doing in a place like this?”

“Again, not a girl. And don’t you think I’m nice?”

“I don’t know you well enough to know if you’re nice. I don’t even know your name.”

“I’m Kate.”

“Hi Kate. Is it terrible if I hope you’re not too nice?”

Kate put a hand on his arm as she laughed. She hoped he didn’t take it the wrong way, because she wasn’t laughing at him, but the situation. It was absurd that she was there in her old college hangout on a Saturday night being hit on by a college kid. And Cal had game, certainly more game than Alexi had. The bartender just relied on his looks, which obviously worked. It could have been depressing if she thought about the reason why she was there alone, but Kate chose to have fun with it. Kate deserved to have some fun, didn’t she? Daniel was probably home coming too fast in his little tart of a hygienist. Kate wouldn’t do anything like that, she told herself once again. She would not go home with Alexi and certainly wouldn’t do anything with this boy. But having a man show some attention—even if it was from such a young guy—felt good, as long as she kept it in perspective. First Alexi, and now Cal. Kate was feeling pretty good about herself.

"I don't know if my husband thinks I'm all that nice," she replied, watching closely for his reaction.

"Maybe he just doesn't appreciate you if you've been married too long. Where is he tonight?"

"He's back at home," she said, starting with the truth. But added, "I wanted to go out and have fun. He couldn't keep up."

"Too bad for him."

"Let me guess, Cal. Good for you?"

"Something like that, Kate. If you're looking for fun, I'm a fun guy."

"I'm sure you are, but I'm not sure we're looking for the same kind of fun tonight."

"You don't know what kind of fun I like, Kate. We could be looking for exactly the same kind of fun."

"I know you're—what—twenty-one, twenty-two, and I'm... married." Kate cut off from admitting her age to the younger man. It didn't matter anyway. She was just having fun with Cal, and she just needed him to know that flirty fun was where the night was going to end. Kate wouldn't even be doing that if she weren't all worked up from Alexi. Her lingering frustration from the bartender was Cal's gain.

"Actually, I'm twenty-four. I did a stint in the Army before school. And you're married, but you're here alone on a Saturday night. So, let's hang out and see what kind of fun we can have. Unless you need to rush home to your husband?"

"No, I am not rushing home tonight," she replied, ignoring the twist of her gut the mention of Daniel provoked. "As long as you understand what tonight isn't going to be."

Cal smiled so innocently that he almost pulled it off and made her believe him, but the twenty-five years of experience Kate had on him allowed her to see right through it. "No expectations," he said.

"No expectations," she echoed.

"So, how about that game?"

"I've lost interest in shuffleboard, and I'm empty," she said, draining her beer. "You should buy me another drink."

Cal downed the remainder of his beer too. "What a coincidence. I'm dry too. What's your poison, Kate?"

Kate linked her arm in his and replied, "Let's go together and see what they have."

The pretty female bartender's surprise at seeing Kate arm in arm with Cal made the older woman squeamish. The confidence she'd gained from the younger men flirting with her evaporated away much easier than she'd gained it. She slipped her arm out of Cal's and refused to make eye contact with the bartender.

"What'll it be, Cal?" the bartender asked.

"Whatever the lady wants, plus a couple shots. What's your poison, Kate?"

"I'll have a Yuengling," Kate mumbled, adding, "I don't know about shots."

"A shot isn't going to kill you. I know you can handle it, but if you really don't want to..."

Kate was being lame, and she knew it. She was angry at her weakness, and realized it wasn't just about shrinking in the face of the anonymous bartender's judgment, but Daniel's affair made her feel weak. It wasn't her fault that Daniel cheated, but she felt she should have fixed their marriage sooner, and she should have thrown her husband out of the house, rather than going away and leaving him in it. Kate's backbone stiffened and she plastered on a smile. It was time to be the Kate she wanted to be. The Kate Alexi had seen in her downstairs.

"We'll have two shots of Fireball, please. Make them doubles."

Kate dug in her pocket and fished out two twenties, throwing them onto the bar. The cash banished the bartender's judgment, and the girl found her own smile, fake enough to match Kate's.

"Will there be anything else, ma'am?" she asked.

"I'll let you know if there is, sweetie," Kate replied, smirking. She gathered the plastic cups containing their shots and walked away, leaving Cal to grab their beers and scrambled in her wake. Kate found an empty couch along the back wall and deposited herself onto it, thankful the poor lighting prevented her from truly seeing the state of the decrepit furniture. Fully sober and in broad daylight, Kate never would have sat on the thing.

"Trade you a beer for a shot," Cal offered, sitting beside her.

Kate swapped a shot for her beer and held the beer on her lap while raising the shot. "What are we drinking to?"

"How about new friends and taking chances?" Cal suggested.

"I'll always drink to new friends, but I'm not sure about taking chances."

“Taking chances is what makes life interesting, right? And I don’t see you as boring, Kate.”

Rather than reply, Kate tipped her drink into her mouth, swallowing half the double shot. True to its name, the Fireball scorched her mouth and throat with its spicy warmth. It was so different than the straight whiskey. The Fireball’s impact on her was more immediate than the straight whiskey’s too. Its heat raced through her chest like wildfire, leaving a warm, tingling glow. She smiled at the once-familiar feeling. Fireball was Kate’s shot of choice in her college days.

Cal knocked back his entire shot, tipping the last drops from the plastic cup over his open mouth in an exaggerated gesture. He licked his lips and said, “I’m disappointed, Kate. I thought you’d do the whole thing.”

She laughed. “Those days are gone. I don’t know why I’m doing shots at all. I’ve done more of them tonight than I probably have in the past ten or fifteen years.”

“You’re just rediscovering your inner party girl. I bet you’ve missed her.”

“Maybe. Sometimes I wonder where she’s gone.”

“And here she is. Are you going to finish that? If not...” Cal reached for the remainder of her shot.

“Hey! Hands off! I didn’t say I wasn’t drinking it.”

Kate dangerously waved him off, threatening to slosh the potent drink out of the little cup. She raised it quickly and threw it back. The second hit didn’t bring the shock of the first, but it did go right to her head. Kate felt giddy for a moment, giggling as she stared at Cal with slightly unfocused eyes. She sipped her beer, as if that would help the burning in her mouth, but the mix of beer and Fireball was disgusting, and she almost spit out the beer.

“You okay? You look like you just swallowed something awful.”

“I’m fine,” she replied, wiping her lips with the back of her hand. “I can swallow anything.” The last comment just popped out, and she blamed the shots. It was not the sort of thing adult, responsible mother Kate said. Maybe Cal was right and college party girl Kate was coming out again.

“Good to know.”

“Haha. I am done with this.” Kate sat her beer on the floor by the couch. The silly, heady feeling from that last shot persisted and she knew she’d had too much. It was time to slow down so she didn’t embarrass herself by

needing to be carried back to her hotel. Kate was sure Cal would be happy to provide that service, but she was not bringing the young man back to her room—even if he was looking even cuter after the second shot.

“Yeah? Do I need to cut you off?” Cal inquired.

“I’m not *drunk* drunk. I still have all my faculties, but I don’t want to get sloppy and embarrass myself.”

“Of course not, Kate. You have a reputation to protect, I’m sure.”

“Correct. I’m not the kind of woman who goes to college bars and goes crazy.”

“You could end up dancing on the bar or something. What would people think?”

Kate smiled. “Maybe I don’t care what people think tonight.”

“Yeah?”

“I mean, why should I? Other people do whatever they want. Why shouldn’t I?”

“I say, do what you like.”

“That’s right. I should just do what I like.”

“And what do you want to do, Kate?”

Being so nakedly propositioned by a college guy almost young enough to be her kid was shocking, and Kate would have laughed if she were completely sober, but she was drunk enough to appreciate it. Cal’s interest added to the warm glow ignited by the Fireball. That glow kept her from thinking clearly as she pondered his question. What did she want? Why was Kate sitting in the poorly lit lounge with a man half her age, who was becoming more attractive by the second. Why had she made out with Alexi in the alley? The desire he’d ignited in her was throbbing through Kate’s body as she sat with Cal. She knew she was very close to making a bad choice. She shouldn’t, but it was becoming harder to find reasons not to. Kate had put her beer down to keep from getting hammered and doing anything reckless, but it was too late for that. She pondered what she wanted, and the answer was an overwhelming urge to kiss Cal. Out in the alley, Alexi was the aggressor, but that wasn’t what she wanted this time.

Kate sprang across the short distance between them, nearly landing in Cal’s lap, and kissed him, knocking her glasses up her face. She bumped into his beer and felt it soak her belly through her t-shirt, but she was too focused on the boy to care. She grabbed the back of his head and thrust her tongue into his mouth, kissing him as if she’d been locked in a convent for

years. Cal began to kiss her back, and as he realized what was happening, an arm went around her waist, pulling Kate even closer. Her knee planted between his legs, and he bent backward as she leaned in and dropped her now-empty plastic shot glass on the floor behind the couch. That hand was free to squeeze Cal's shoulder and caress his back. He was firm under his soft, worn cotton t-shirt, his body tight in a way her husband's hadn't been for decades.

Cal pressed forward, taking back the initiative. He broke the kiss, briefly, to set his beer on the floor, which pressed his face into Kate's tits. He kissed her there, through her t-shirt. Both hands then held her back, pushing her chest into his face. Kate felt silly having his face mashed into her clothed chest and used his unruly black hair to pull him back into their kiss. She nipped at his lips, pulling his bottom lip with sharp teeth, before getting lost in his wet lips again. Cal continued coming forward, while holding her in place, and Kate realized the lump pressing into her knee was his hard cock—and he was grinding it against her. That physical manifestation of Cal's desire for her made Kate's heart triphammer in her chest. Feeling his hard cock made it all real. This kid wanted to fuck her as much as Alexi had. And Kate just might let him. The resolve she'd had in the alley was nearly gone. She wiggled her knee as he rubbed against it, signaling she knew what he was doing.

Kate twisted and deposited her butt in his lap. She swore his hard-on surged against her round, soft bottom, and she wiggled that too. She thought she had a nice ass for a woman her age. It had a nice curve—especially in those jeans—and was kept firm by regular workouts. She wouldn't want Cal comparing it to a coed's, she was forty-eight after all, but she had a nice ass all the same.

His hands freely roamed her body, and in the dim light of the upstairs lounge, she let them. He lingered on her hip, squeezed her butt, then roved back up to cup her breast. Cal was smooth with his hands, implying he had a lot more experience than she would have expected from a twenty-four-year-old. He massaged her tits without manhandling them and coaxed her nipples to hardness, even through her bra and t-shirt. She felt Cal's excitement when he touched her, unlike Daniel these days. On the rare occasions she had sex with her husband, it felt like he was going through the motions to get to the part where he put his dick in her.

Cal swept her honey blonde hair aside and kissed his way down along the side of her neck. Thrills shot up her spine, and when he nibbled by her collarbone, Kate couldn't stifle her soft gasp. Cal focused there, nibbling and sucking, making her tremble. She finally pulled his head back by the hair, softly admonishing, "You can't leave a mark."

"Sorry, didn't mean to get carried away, but you're fucking hot, Kate. Can't blame me." Cal whispered his response between kisses.

"Cal... just be careful... my husband..."

"Let you go out alone. He deserves this. He deserves me fucking you tonight."

"Cal, I don't know..."

Cal cut her off with another kiss and he throbbed against her ass. He seriously wanted to fuck her tonight. Kate had never been so torn. Life wasn't so complicated the last time she made out with a boy on one of the couches at Carey's. Back then, she would have let a cute boy like Cal do what he liked there in the dimness. She would have welcomed his hand up the short skirts she wore back in her college days. But she was a married woman now, not a twenty-year-old coed. The guilt pressed in again. Daniel's unfaithfulness didn't license her own adultery. And yet, she wanted it. God, did she want it. Kate was rather wet. She felt it when she squeezed her thighs together, wiggling her ass for Cal. She wanted to feel the way a twenty-four-year-old guy could fuck again, and the shots told her she should. If it weren't for those last shots of Fireball, Kate might have been out of there, but they warmed her and gave Kate all sorts of bad ideas.

Kate was too caught in her weak moral struggle to notice Cal's hand push under her t-shirt. His fingers glided over her lightly padded bra before yanking it up and out of his way. His hand was warm and dry when he palmed the hot flesh of her tits. Her nipples popped to full attention, pale pink bullets burrowing into his palm as she kneaded her pliable flesh. Hormones raged and she pushed against his hand and moaned into this kiss. *Yes, this is just what you needed!* The dirty part of her brain shouted. But then Cal pulled at the snap on her jeans and Kate had a moment of clarity. *What are you doing? You can't let this kid strip you in this bar! There are people around!* Her rational brain screamed. It was the same panic that stopped her in the alley.

"Cal...wait...we can't...not here..." she panted, staring at him through smudged glasses.

“I want you, Kate. You want it. I feel it. Let’s go. Your place is out?”

She’d shut Alexi right now, making it clear it wasn’t going to go further. That wasn’t in her mind now. Kate wanted to be alone with Cal somewhere private. She had a hotel but taking him there was a terrible idea. The image of dragging this college boy through the hotel lobby and up to her room was absurd. Kate couldn’t do that. The room was booked in her and Daniel’s names and she irrationally feared the desk clerk would judge her as she passed by, seeing her as a wanton slut.

“We can’t go there,” she whispered, trying to slow her heart so she could think clearly.

“Let’s go to my place.”

“I don’t know.”

Cal gave her a fiery kiss and a light pinch to her nipple jolting pleasure straight to her pussy. That wasn’t going to help clear thinking. Thoughts raced through her brain. Kate wondered how many roommates Cal had and if they could slip into his room unseen.

“Are you sure?” she asked.

“My roommate has a girlfriend. He’ll be out all night. C’mon, Kate.”

“Okay,” she breathed, answering without thinking.

FOUR

KATE FROZE WHEN CAL LED HER TO TAGGART HALL. IT WAS A DORM she was intimately familiar with. One of her college boyfriends roomed there and Kate spent almost as much time in his room that semester as she did in hers. The dorm floors were segregated by gender back then, and Kate always felt vulnerable being the only girl on a floor of guys when she had to run to the bathroom or sneak out in the middle of the night. All the leering boys knew exactly what she'd been up to in that dorm room. Those old worries popped up in her mind as Cal pulled her by the hand, leading her to the front door of Taggart Hall.

"Cal, wait. I can't go into your dorm," she protested, planting her feet, and stopping them on the lawn in front of the building.

"No one cares, Kate. The whole dorm is coed now."

"I'm not *that* old, Cal. We had coed dorms in my time. They were separated by floors, but they were coed.

"That's not how it is anymore. I have girls right next door to me. There are girls all over my floor. No one will even notice us."

"I'm not just another college girl, Cal."

"That's what makes you so hot," he replied, trying to pull her into a kiss.

"Cal, not here," she complained.

Kate's stomach flipped, while her body burned with frustration. The short walk across the humid campus had sharpened her focus, pulling Kate out of her Fireball-induced haze. They didn't pass any adults—anyone *Kate* considered an adult—but she felt the looks the students they passed gave her. They seemed split between thinking Kate was a visiting parent on

campus with her son—even if they were pressed oddly close for parent and child—and seeing the situation for what it was, cheering Cal for bagging the drunken MILF. Neither reaction pleased Kate. She'd just been in Cal's lap making out with him. She did not want to be confused with his mother. She also didn't want them thinking she was some drunk, horny housewife out for a thrill—even if that was partially true. So, her stomach churned as the very strong desire to fuck Cal warred with the practical thought that this was a terrible idea.

"No one is even going to notice you, Kate. Anyone who's out this late is too drunk to pay attention to us. We'll just slip right into my room."

"This is crazy."

"Don't you want to get a little crazy tonight, Kate? Isn't that why you went to Carey's? Won't fucking in a dorm room be hot?"

Fucking in a dorm room would be *insane*. This was her *daughter's* school. Thank god it wasn't Avery's dorm. God, what if she ran into Avery out here on campus? Her eyes darted around in a sudden fit of paranoia. Kate hoped that party went very late. She didn't want to be out in the open with Cal any longer, and the devil on her shoulder kindly pointed out that his dorm room was the closest place to get away from prying eyes. It just so happened to fit with what Kate *really* wanted. Underneath all of her very reasonable objections, Kate wanted Cal's hard, young dick. She wanted to be fucked in a way she hadn't been fucked in years. She chose to convince herself that anyone they passed would just think she was going back to her son's dorm before heading to a hotel. Justifying what she wanted was easier than Kate expected, and she almost understood how Daniel ended up self-justifying screwing his hygienist.

"Let's go before I change my mind," she told Cal, smiling slyly.

Cal used a card to access the locked front door of Taggart Hall and Kate hoped they could dart to his room, but a security guard was stationed at a desk just inside the door. Kate froze. She was not ready to explain her presence to security. When she was in school, students worked the front desk and most of them hardly paid attention to their jobs—if they were even present when they were supposed to be. The guard seemed friendly enough. He was just a couple years older than Cal and wore an ill-fitting polyester uniform.

"Hey, Jerry, my mom is just here to grab something. You don't mind if she just runs up with me, do you?" Cal asked, radiating innocent intent.

“Yeah, that’s not a problem. Nice to meet you Mrs. Steinmetz,” the guard replied, glancing up from his phone.

Kate had lost the power of speech but managed a little wave while her pale cheeks flushed deeper crimson with each passing second.

“We don’t need to do the sign in bullshit, do we?” Cal asked.

“Not for your mom. Have a good night,” the guard said.

Cal took Kate’s arm and led her away toward the elevators. Kate sighed with relief when the elevator doors immediately slid open. She pulled Cal inside. He hit the button for the fifth floor.

“Really? Your mom? Way to kill the mood, Cal.”

“I didn’t think you wanted to have to show ID and sign in. It seemed like the easiest way. Besides, I can get you right back in the mood, Kate.”

Cal pushed her against the back wall of the cramped elevator and gave her a breath stealing kiss, gently tugging her hair and grabbing her ass. Kate sagged into him and let the kiss carry her—until she realized the elevator might have a security camera. She pushed Cal away and looked up at the corners. There was no obvious camera, but Kate wasn’t taking chances.

“Hold on to that until we’re in your room, handsome,” she said playfully.

Kate tunneled her vision and fixed her eyes straight ahead as Cal led her to his dorm room, ignoring the students they encountered on the way. She didn’t want to speculate what they thought was happening. Cal unlocked his door and she shoved him aside to barrel through the doorway. It didn’t matter that the move made her appear overeager. Kate was very eager to bed the college student—despite how her nerves increased with every student they passed. She needed it to happen before she chickened out.

The dorm room was essentially the same as her daughter’s, except the beds were loft beds with desk space and storage beneath each. It opened the room, leaving spare space where the desks otherwise would have been. A bean bag chair had been thrown in part of that space, and the rest was filled with shelving and a TV too big for the space.

Kate was disoriented by a weird wave of cognitive dissonance, being in a dorm room with the intent to hook up, like the last twenty-five years hadn’t happened. She was suddenly twenty again, backing up in a tight dorm room while a cute boy hungrily eyed her up with a predatory grin. Kate felt the same buzzy excitement she did back then, partially fueled by

too many shots at Carey's. She was usually left feeling slutty in the morning, but she rarely truly regretted her behavior.

Cal backed her up against the ladder to his bed and held Kate's face in both hands as he kissed her, pulling off her ballcap and tossing it away. She grabbed the front of his shirt to pull him closer before pushing her hands under it and wrapping her arms around him. His taunt back felt nice and smooth—so different from her husband's body. With every touch and kiss, Kate was reminded that she was *not* with her husband, which triggered alarm bells in her brain. Her every action felt wrong, but the desire that hummed inside her pushed that alarm aside.

Cal pulled at her shirt and Kate raised her arms so he could whip it off and toss it aside. His hands flew to her tits, kneading them like he'd never felt tits before, as his excitement got the better of him. Kate wore a basic navy blue bra—more about comfort than style—and wished she'd chosen something sexier. She would have if she'd thought anyone would be seeing her without her top. The hookup turned frantic as they kissed wildly, and Kate grabbed at Cal's shirt while he fumbled with the snap on her jeans. They were at cross purposes trying to undress each other. Cal's shirt was tangled and twisted on his body and Kate felt inept. She couldn't even remember the last time she'd tried to undress a man. Daniel was almost always stripped down to his boxers before they started, as they were already in bed. And their encounters were never this charged or frantic.

Kate lost the struggle. Cal sank to his knees, pulling free of her grasp. Her jeans were unbuttoned and unzipped, but they were tight over her hips and butt, and Kate had to wiggle for Cal to yank them down. Black cotton panties—again, not sexy enough for a casual hookup—were dragged down too, resting cockeyed on her hips. He helpfully removed her sneakers so Kate could step out of her jeans. Cal was smooth and in control now, like this was his move, and Kate wondered how many girls he'd stripped in this dorm room. Kate had a chilling thought, that one of those girls could have been Avery. *Do not let your mind go there!*

Cal only freed one ankle from her jeans before his impatience got the better of him. He kissed his way up her leg, stubble tickling her inner thigh. He was so close he had to catch the tangy scent of her excitement. A damp spot had spread on the front her panties. Daniel didn't make that happen these days. Cal nuzzled her mound through her panties. Kate shivered as the mad tingling turned her restless. It was like an army of ants crawled up her

body. The potent tangle of excitement and the wrongness of her act was unlike anything Kate had ever felt. It was overwhelming and Kate was ashamed to admit she loved it. It was so incredible she could see it becoming additive. Cal kissed between her legs and wet sounds filled the room as he sucked her lips through her panties. It felt strange and wonderful.

Kate moaned loudly and raked her manicured nails through his hair. Her hips jerked, pushing her pussy at him. He peeled the panties from her mound and spread her lips, kissing her juicy center. She gasped and hooked a leg over his shoulder, twisting her body and jamming her pussy at him. Her pulse raced so fast she felt dizzy. It wasn't just that Cal was good with his tongue—the kid had skills—but the whole situation that blew her mind. His thumb kept her spread open while his tongue darted into her pink, lapping like he couldn't get enough of her tart taste. That thumb massaged, the blunt tip working up and grazing her clit. Pleasure throbbed through Kate so intense she wanted to scream. Her free hand stretched up and grabbed the ladder above her head, locking onto the rung. She looked like she was stretched out on the rack as Cal devoured her pussy.

Cal pushed his thick thumb into her pussy. It didn't go deeply, but he wiggled it like a pro, teasing her sensitive entrance and hitting that special spot when he angled it just right. He sucked and licked the button of her clit—his tongue strobing across it in a rapid flicker. The coup de grace was when he stretched a finger down and forced it between her cheeks. He didn't try to penetrate her, but he tickled her tight little rosebud. No one ever touched her there. It was so foreign that Kate yelped and jumped, but Cal held her firm. The gently massaging fingertip on her tight knot rapidly went from uncomfortable to wildly delicious. Cal's expert fingers and ravenous mouth on her clit brought Kate's orgasm on so quickly that she wailed in ecstasy, knowing full well she'd be heard beyond Cal's dorm room. Every nerve lit up at once and she saw bright fireworks behind her tightly closed eyes. Kate's body twisted and turned, and it was unclear if she was trying to escape the overwhelming pleasure or trap the kid there forever. Cal slurped away at her pussy, not tiring as he drank her juices. He didn't stop until she used her grip on his hair to pull him away from her dripping pussy. Kate was left weak and panting and nearly slipped down the ladder to melt to the floor.

Kate turned and leaned against the ladder for support, resting a knee on it. It looked like she was ready to climb up to his bed, but she needed a moment to catch her breath and gather her orgasm-scattered wits. She hadn't been smacked that hard by a climax in ages. Sessions with her favorite toy were nice, but it didn't make her come like that. Daniel certainly didn't make her come that hard anymore. For one thing, he hadn't gone down on her in recent memory. An anniversary may have been the last time. To be fair, she hadn't blown him in just as long—except Kate was willing to do it for Daniel. Daniel just wasn't interested. And now she knew why. Her husband's infidelity fired Kate. She was going to fuck young Cal like a succubus. Kate purred when she felt his warm hands on her back and hip.

Cal had stripped while her back was turned. His bare body molded to her back as he swept her hair aside and kissed her neck. Kate sighed and hung her head forward. Her heart rate was only just calming, and Cal had it racing again. He unsnapped her bra, and she shook it off. Her pulled her panties down and she finally stepped out of the other leg of her jeans, leaving her unencumbered. Cal's hands slipped around her, cupping both breasts. He gently pinched and rolled her nipples between his fingers while he massaged her tits. He'd calmed enough to resist just mauling them, but Cal was no less excited. His hard cock, hot and thick, pressed into her back, leaving a smear of sticky fluid on her skin as it rubbed against her. It was the first time she'd felt a dick that wasn't her husband's in decades. The realization was a shock to her system. Kate was naked with another man. She felt his cock—a cock that was probably moments from penetrating her. The events of the night—the last couple days—that led Kate to that moment were hazy in her brain, clouded from focus by her lust-soaked brain, but feeling Cal's cock brought them into sharp focus.

The sense of unease at her imminent adultery that kept guttering in and out like a torch in the wind flashed brightly again. For a moment, she almost did the right thing and stopped Cal. She looked up and saw the diamond glinting on her finger, a beacon to her marriage. But Cal's attention to her tits, his nibbling on her neck, and his cock insistently poking her back extinguished the flame of her moral discomfort. Kate had a free pass to do as she pleased, and she *really* wanted Cal to use her body.

Cal pulled back on her hips and pushed between her shoulders, making Kate lean forward so her ass jutted out. She glanced back over her shoulder

to see him kneeling again, just as he buried his face between her thighs again.

“Cal...honey...you...don’t...ohmygod...have to...ahh...”

Kate felt guilty that this kid had done everything for her so far, but also reveled in it. No one had worshipped her body like this in so long. She hadn’t known how badly she needed it. Cal sucked at her pussy like it was the juiciest peach. His tongue danced on her clit. Kate trembled and clung to the ladder, pushing her ass at Cal like she was twerking. She whimpered with disappointment when his mouth left her pussy, but two fingers filled her right off and Kate hoped he was ready to finally fuck her.

Cal’s tongue flicked back, tickling her taint, and he pulled her cheeks apart as his tongue continued its journey. Kate tensed when the younger man teased her rosebud a second time, but it wasn’t his probing fingertip this time. His slippery tongue flicked all around her clenched knot like an inquisitive flame seeking oxygen. Kate had no idea how to feel about the strange intrusion and squirmed like she was trying to shake him off her ass. But Cal’s fingers kept plumbing her pussy—Kate was so wet she heard them squishing into her—and his tongue pressed insistently at her rosebud. His tongue poked at it with purpose and squirmed its way into her knot.

Kate didn’t know why she allowed Cal to eat her ass. She blamed her already inflamed state. Cal had her so worked up she might have allowed him to do anything to her. He’d just given Kate her best orgasm in years. His demanding tongue kept poking at her rosebud, and she relaxed, enjoying the strange, squirmy feeling. Cal’s slippery tongue squeezed through her relaxed knot and penetrated her ass. The surge of weird pleasure turned her knees rubbery. Kate clung to the ladder for support. Pleasure throbbed from her pussy, where his fingers relentlessly fucked her. The slippery sensations of Cal’s tongue and his pistoning fingers twisted Kate’s brain. A low moan escaped her lips, and she hugged the ladder to keep from slipping to the floor. Cal felt her quivering orgasm and relented, moving back up behind her, and supporting Kate with his arm around her waist.

“Damn you’re sexy, Kate. I can’t believe how hot you are. Your pussy’s fucking soaked, babe,” Cal marveled, kissing her neck and nibbling her ear from behind.

“Please... fuck me, Cal. I want your dick,” Kate whimpered. The responsible adult in her couldn’t believe her words, but Kate the MILF had

taken over, and she wanted Cal's young cock.

Cal boosted her up the ladder. Kate bumped her head on the ceiling as she crawled onto his bed and turned around, flipping onto her back. The younger man was right behind her, crawling between her legs and lifting them over his forearms. His cock waggled between his legs, standing out hard and proud, bouncing right above its target. Kate grabbed his hard shaft and tugged it. His hot flesh filled her hand, leaving just enough room to close her fingers—much thicker than her husband. It was the first chance she had to see Cal's prick, let alone touch it. He grunted as she tugged it. A long strand sticky precum dripped from the end, extending a wet string down to her mound.

"Don't do that too long," he warned between grunts.

Cal stared down at her body beneath him, eyes sweeping from where his cock drooled onto her pussy to her tits, spread to the sides. Kate lamented that he wasn't used to seeing fortysomething tits like hers unless he routinely brought MILFs to his bed. She was getting more comfortable thinking of herself as that—a MILF. Cal stared at her tits hungrily, though, reassuring Kate.

"Why's that?" she purred.

"Because I want to fuck you, Kate, unless you want me to blow my load all over your stomach and tits."

Kate smiled. "No, I definitely want you to fuck me, Cal."

Kate used her free hand to pull him down into a kiss. Her legs were bent back to the breaking point, and she was thankful for the time spent at the gym and doing yoga. As she kissed Cal, Kate pulled her smeared glasses off and laid them on the bed beside her. Kate pointed his cock lower, and it slipped across her lips.

Cal took the hint and speared her. Kate gasped into their kiss. The gasp changed to a low groan as he sank his thick shaft deep inside her. He filled her with one long, slow thrust, ending with his shank fully embedded in her. Cal felt incredible and Kate throbbed around him. It was Kate's first new cock in almost twenty years, and it was fantastic. Cal pulled back from their kiss to watch her as he stirred his cock in her without pulling out.

"Fuck, your eyes are beautiful. They're so fucking blue."

"Th...thanks, Cal. You're incredible too," Kate moaned, thinking of his filling cock, not his eyes. She couldn't even think of the color of his eyes while he was buried in her.

“Fuck, you feel good, Kate. Fuck!”

Kate held onto his forearms and dug her nails in, pulling as she lifted her hips at him. Cal responded, pulling out to pin her back to the thin dorm room mattress with a powerful thrust. It stole her breath, stifling an incipient moan. Cal took her that way, with leisurely, powerful thrusts, seemingly enjoying watching Kate’s reaction. Her icy blue eyes flashed at him, encouraging him to take her harder. Her hips urged him too. Kate wasn’t there to be teased. She was there to be *fucked*.

Cal got it in gear and the loft bed creaked and rocked beneath them. Kate feared it might collapse, but even that added excitement to the experience. Her legs were pinned back and spread wide. Her feet bounced in the air as Cal pounded her harder and harder. The wet sounds of their coupling filled the echoey dorm room. Kate was a bit embarrassed by how wet Cal made her. When was the last time Daniel made her *squish* with excitement? She panted *yeah, yeah* between moans, encouraging her young lover to fuck her harder and harder. Her pussy hugged his thick cock, and each powerful thrust sent a wave of ecstasy crashing through her body. Kate knew she seemed like an easy lay to the college kid, looking to get her kicks with a younger man, but she was past caring. He could think anything he liked as long as he kept fucking her like that.

Kate kept her eyes closed and focused on that cock driving her to the next climax. She tried to live in the moment and not think about the reality that she was now just as bad as Daniel. She was committing adultery too. And just like with her husband, Kate had found a much younger partner. She wasn’t any better than Daniel—not anymore—even if he did it first. She didn’t care about ceding the moral high ground and being bad. It felt too good. A high-pitched cry started deep in her throat and slipped from her lips as her toes curled and her body stiffened. Her pussy locked around that pounding cock and Kate came once again, the pleasure blossoming in her like a wildflower. She thought Cal would come with her. Daniel always came when she did—if he lasted long enough, but Cal kept fucking her through her orgasm, lengthening it until Kate was losing her mind.

Kate pushed on his chest, making Cal stop. She was panting and needed a breather, but she also wanted to change it up. “Turn over,” she panted.

The narrow loft bed was tight, requiring careful choreography to keep either of them from falling over the side as they maneuvered, but Cal turned onto his back and Kate straddled him. He kept his erection through the

complicated movement, and she stuffed him back inside her. She had to stay low because of the lack of headroom, but Kate managed. She planted a hand on each of his shoulders and worked her hips. Kate pinned Cal to the bed and used his young body, becoming the aggressor. Her tits swayed beneath her, and Cal cupped them, pinching and pulling her nipples. Kate cried out and threw her head back while biting her lip.

“Fuck, that’s hot! Fuck, *you’re* hot, Kate. Goddam it, that feels fucking good.”

Kate leaned down, staring at Cal as her blonde hair curtained around her face. The scorching lust on his face ignited her. Seeing how he wanted her was thrilling. She rode him hard, harder than he rode her, sliding on his body, jamming onto his cock, and crying out every time that thick cock stretched her pussy. It was like she felt him everywhere inside her. Kate never thought size mattered, but Cal’s thick tool did things to her she didn’t think were possible. The loft bed strained to contain them, the violence of their rocking threatening to tear it apart at the joints. The wood loudly clacked against the cinderblock wall behind the headboard. She was surprised the ruckus didn’t bring a knock at the door from the RA. Kate only rode him harder, almost hoping to be the woman to destroy his bed.

Cal peeled her cheeks apart and his finger was back at her rosebud. Kate didn’t slow, but she did clench. “It’s okay, Kate. You’ll love it. Just relax, babe.”

“Cal...uhn...”

Cal used her momentum against her. When Kate thrust back onto his cock, he held his finger tip against her anus and it popped right past the seal. She yelped, but he kept worming that digit deeper. Kate grunted and finally slowed, unsure about the burning pain in her ass. But Cal kept working that finger, gentle and firm, and the burning turned to a throbbing pleasure she couldn’t deny.

“Don’t stop, Kate. Keep fucking me. Don’t stop, you need that dick, Katie,” Cal urged.

Kate almost laughed. She hadn’t been called Katie in almost forty years. It was strange for her boy toy to call her Katie—especially with his finger up her ass—but she liked it. *Kate* was the responsible wife and mother. *Katie* was the MILF who fucked college boys in their dorm rooms. Katie resumed riding Cal hard, and his finger wedged deeper in her ass. It became incredible. The finger in her tight ass and the thick cock in her pussy made

her whole body throb and flash. Katie was overwhelmed and rode Cal like she would die if she stopped.

“Yeah...yeah...yeah...YEAH!” she cried, wailing as the most intense orgasm of the night tore through her. Her cries turned to howls and she froze with his finger and cock embedded in her.

Cal used his grip on her ass and a hand on her hip to get Kate moving again, while thrusting up from beneath. His thrusts were quick and deep, and Cal grunted with each one. Kate read the signs and panicked. She didn’t want the young man coming inside her.

“Cal! Wait!” she cried.

Kate slid off his cock and almost off the foot of the loft bed as she scrambled to grab his slippery cock and get it in her mouth. She sucked his cock without even thinking, her cheeks hollowing as she bobbed. He only lasted seconds longer, filling Kate’s mouth with a huge, sticky load as his balls drained into her hungry mouth. She choked on the mess in her mouth, and it dripped from her lips. Kate hadn’t swallowed in over a decade. Even if she did go down on her husband, it was just to get him hard enough to fuck her. She pushed Cal to the back of her throat and swallowed the rest of it, marveling that the kid kept coming and coming. The tangy taste of her pussy mingled with his brackish load, but she sucked and swallowed and licked his cock like it was the sweetest treat. Kate could get used to taking loads in her mouth again if she was properly motivated.

Cal stared down his chest at her with a huge smile. Kate let him slip from her lips and laughed, asking, “What?”

“Just you, Kate. You’re just fucking incredible. Really, you’re fucking incredible.” He pushed her hair back from her face. “You’re beautiful and sexy and hot. I don’t know how I got so lucky tonight.”

She kept laughing. “You got me in bed. You can stop now.” She slid up his body and snuggled in next to him on the narrow bed. His arm went around her, his hand landing on her ass.

“You don’t know how to take a compliment, do you? I mean every word. That was fucking wild.”

“It was pretty wild for me, Cal. I don’t do this sort of thing. It’s not me. Not really.”

“It was you tonight, and I loved every second of it, Katie.”

She kissed his cheek. “You’re really going to make me blush, Cal.”

He touched her cheek. “You’re already pretty hot.”

It was true. She was a sweaty mess. *Not very attractive*, she thought.

“You must think I’m a terrible slut. I meant it, Cal. I’ve never done anything like this before.”

“I’m not judging you, Katie. Whatever you’re up to outside of this room doesn’t matter to me. None of my business. If this is the first time you did this, then I’m lucky that you chose me. And if you do it every Saturday night, I’m still lucky that I got to be the next in line.”

Kate laughed thinking about it, a long line of young men for her to fuck. The idea was hot.

“I feel like I’m the lucky one. I didn’t expect someone like you to go for me. I still don’t get why.”

Cal squeezed her ass. “This is a great ass, Katie. I love the way you shook it at Carey’s. And you’re so beautiful. Those eyes, that smile.”

“Also, old enough to be your mother.” There, she said it.

“I don’t care. Do you?”

“It’s hard not to, a little bit.”

“Listen, I’m a twenty-four-year-old man. I’ve been around. You’re not taking advantage of me. And I doubt you’re old enough to be my mother.”

The math works, she thought. “So, maybe you took advantage of me—the vulnerable older woman.” Kate couldn’t say it without laughing.

“Do you feel taken advantage of?”

“Only in the best way.”

“And what if I’m not done taking advantage of you?”

Cal looked down toward his cock, which was already throbbing back to life. Kate grasped it and stroked it. He really did have a wonderful cock, and she wanted more of it. She should have slunk out of there while she had a shred of dignity left, but that’s not what she did.

“I think I should take advantage of you this time,” she said, smiling wickedly.

Kate bent down and sucked him into her mouth.

EPILOGUE

KATE DID SLINK OUT OF HIS DORM ROOM—THREE HOURS LATER AS THE sky began turning from inky black to midnight blue at the horizon. It was the shamiest walk of shame she'd even done, but there was almost no one out on campus at that hour. The few students she encountered looked right past her. They were on their own walks of shame. Kate blew through the lobby back at her hotel, not looking up to see if the desk clerk had a disapproving look for her.

Cal used her body over and over in those three hours. They fucked in every conceivable position. The college boy showed more imagination in three hours than Daniel had in all their years of marriage. Her husband could have his little tramp if she could have Cal. She rode him sitting in his desk chair, sitting on the desk, bent over the desk, and on his roommates' bed. They snuck into the showers, and they fucked again there, even though Kate was supposed to be making herself presentable. The shower didn't help. She knew anyone looking at her could read what she'd been up to all night as she walked to the hotel.

Kate had a few hours to sleep, but she was still exhausted and sore when she met Avery for brunch. Avery stared at her quizzically all through brunch but didn't dare ask why her mother looked like she'd been partying all night. She could have never guessed the answer. Kate enjoyed the rest of the day with Avery, but then the long drive home came, followed by having to face Daniel. He cheated first, but she still felt guilty. It was just how she was built.

Daniel looked like a wreck when she found him at home. He was disheveled, unshaven, exhausted, with huge dark bags under his eyes. Kate

uncharitably thought he was worn out from spending the weekend with Nya. But he looked worried.

“Kate,” he began.

“Don’t, Daniel. Don’t bother,” she answered, breezing past him, and setting her purse down in the kitchen. Her keys clacked on the counter.

“Kate, we need to talk. I’ve been thinking all weekend. I know what I did, and I know I ruined things, but I don’t want it to be over between us. I’ve been stupid. I...”

“Really, Daniel, save it. I get it now. I really do. I understand how you found sweet Nya irresistible.”

“What? Kate?”

“What, Daniel?” she replied, staring at him with her hand on her hip.

“What did you...”

“Only what you suggested. There were a lot of cute, athletic, *young* guys on campus this weekend.”

“Come on, Kate. You didn’t. I know you. You’d never.”

“Maybe you don’t know me as well as you thought. I thought I knew you.”

Kate came close and put a hand on his chest, smiling up at him. “You took care of yourself. I took care of myself. You’re not going back on your word, are you Daniel? You wanted an open marriage.”

“I didn’t think...”

“You didn’t think I’d really do it? Guess what? It turns out there are still plenty of guys who want to fuck me, even if you don’t. Fit, young guys.”

“You really did?”

“Look at me. What do you think?”

Daniel stared at her, his eyes went wide, and his mouth dropped open as he realized she was serious. Kate wished she had a photo to remember that exact look on his face. She also felt his cock twitch against her. She thought she had to be mistaken, but then it twitched again. Kate just told her husband she’d fucked someone else, and it made him hard. What was going on? *Who was he?*

“You like it,” she accused.

“What? Like what?”

Kate grabbed his cock. Daniel tried to pull away, but when she squeezed it, he throbbed in her hand. “I told you I fucked someone else, and you like it. Don’t lie, I can feel it. That makes you hard, Daniel, knowing some

sweaty college kid was all over me? He rocked my world, Daniel. I lost count of how many times I came with him.”

Daniel surged in her hand. She thought he might just come in his sweatpants.

“This is a new wrinkle, honey. I thought I’d just tell you to have your fun and I’d have my fun, but it seems like you *really like* me having my fun.”

“Kate...” he stammered.

“If you’re very nice, I’ll tell you all about it. I’ll tell you all the filthy little details of how he used your sweet wife this weekend. But only if you’re good, Daniel.”

Daniel groaned and a hot wet spot spread across the front of his sweatpants.

“I need to go wash my hands,” she said with a laugh, leaving her husband in the kitchen.

For the first time in years, Kate was excited. She couldn’t wait to find out what happened next. She thought it was silly when Cal insisted on putting his number in her phone, but now Kate thought it just might come in handy.

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ALSO BY KIRSTEN MCCURRAN

Carol's Trinity:

A Hotwife's Reverse Harem Series

It was a birthday surprise Carol didn't ask for, but she would never forget. Carol had a feeling that things wouldn't be the same after that magical night her husband, John, shared her with three sexy, younger men. She just couldn't anticipate all the ways it would change her. At 40, she feels like a new woman, with powerful new desires.

Conner, Noah and Matteo are never far from her mind in the months afterward, but Carol doesn't quite know how to tell her husband she wants another round with "her guys". Was her 40th birthday present a onetime thing? Isn't it safer if it's left that way? She doesn't want to hurt John's feelings, and she doesn't to come off as a wanton woman. But after a moment of honesty with John, Carol comes home from a morning of yoga to find an incredible surprise waiting for her!

Fiona's Summer Vacation

Fiona was at loose ends with her kid at camp and her husband working endless hours. Faced with all that time and nothing to do, Fiona takes on a project: drawing nerdy young Sam out of his shell and away from his videogames. What seems like a harmless distraction at first, becomes something more as Fiona discovers the young man's crush on her. Surprisingly, Fiona finds herself crushing back as she revels in Sam's attention.

Fiona's husband, Josh, sees no threat and encourages his wife to indulge the young man's crush. He even suggests his wife play Mrs. Robinson to the awkward young man. But it all gets real when Fiona's feelings deepen, and lines are crossed. Fiona is worried by her behavior and annoyed that her husband is not. Can Fiona be a good and loyal wife AND luxuriate in Sam's attention? Can she come to terms with her husband's willingness to share her? The only thing Fiona knows for sure is that she will never be the same after this summer.

Gentrified:

A Wife Seduced

Jessica is a fish out of water when her husband, Kyle, moves their family from the cushy suburbs to a fixer-upper in an up-and-coming neighborhood. The new arrivals get the cold shoulder from most of the neighborhood old-timers, except for one. Winston has designs on Jessica the moment he sees her on the street. After deciding he must have her, Winston sets about seducing the pretty young mom, and making sure he has her husband's blessing.

But no great plan comes off without a hitch, and when Winston meets Jessica's best friend Nicole he finds his attention split. Can Winston seduce Jessica while romancing her best friend? Will Nicole be a wrench in his plans, or become an unexpected ally?

Stephanie's Hotwife Seduction

Stephanie is on a rare date night with her husband Andy when they spy a curious sight. Her coworker Dez, an attractive younger black man, is out with an older white couple. Curiosity gets the better of her and Stephanie asks Dez what his deal is. Dez explains he's a Bull and a whole new world is opened to Stephanie and Andy.

Stephanie can't help but be tempted by the hotwife lifestyle...and her handsome coworker. Will Stephanie lose herself to her new lifestyle or can Andy reel her back in and keep the woman he fell in love with?

Shoot the Messenger:

A Hotwife Adventure

A favor to his wife Haley turns Matt's life upside down. Matt is fixing her computer when an instant message comes through from an old flame, Travis, her college boyfriend. Haley and Travis had a wild, crazy time together, and their affair burned so hot, it had to burn out. It's a time in her life that Matt has always been obsessed with, so seeing Travis pop up in their lives again sends Matt into a tailspin.

Matt watches in fascinated horror as Travis digitally seduces Haley. The old Haley, up for anything, comes out again, and Matt feels that old obsession return. Thoughts of Haley being with Travis again drive arouse and tear him apart. And Travis will get a chance to have his way when they all attend a wedding together. Can Haley resist her ultimate temptation? And will Matt stand by and let her go through with it just to satisfy his own twisted fantasies?

Hawaiian Swing

After 10 years of marriage the flame isn't quite gone, but it's flickering, so Kristen and Steve head off on a second honeymoon to find the magic again. But some things are easier said than done. The demands of being a wife and mother—physical and mental—have Kristen wondering if she can ever again be the passionate, exciting woman Steve met back in college. Just when she thinks getting her mojo back is out of reach, they meet a sexy younger couple intent on turning their world upside down. Kristen doesn't mind that her husband is infatuated with pretty blonde Ambyr, because when she sees herself through the eyes of tall, hunky and tattooed Riley, Kristen finds her passion burning hotter than ever.

These and other titles are available at online booksellers.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Kirsten McCurran is the nom de plume of an average fortysomething woman with a dirty mind and the drive to share her vivid fantasies. She is especially interested in tales of women like her, who are tempted by the forbidden and give in—only to discover the complications that can cause. Like many of her characters, Kirsten lives in the ‘burbs with her loving husband and children, so she understands how difficult it might be for one of her characters to balance a real life with her erotic adventures. Her neighbors may be scandalized to discover what is going on in her head, but Kirsten’s husband fully approves, and even lends a hand in the creative process where he can.

Kirsten has written over 40 ebooks, all of which can be found on Amazon. Some are available in other formats on BN.com and Smashwords. She loves to hear from her fans and can be reached on Twitter [@kirstenmccurran](https://twitter.com/kirstenmccurran) or by email at kmccurran@gmail.com. Checkout Kirsten’s [Amazon Author page](#).

